- *Use a different handler for every product in your product range.* That approach would be unfeasible for almost any realistically sized product range.
- *Use a single handler, and use the query string to differentiate among products.* This approach is much more practical, but you'd end up with somewhat-ugly URLs, such as `"/product?name=big-widget"` or `"/product?id=12"`.

DEFINITION The *query string* is part of a URL containing additional data that doesn't fit in the path. It isn't used by the routing infrastructure to identify which handler to execute, but ASP.NET Core can extract values from the query string automatically in a process called *model binding*, as you'll see in chapter 7. The query string in the preceding example is `id=12`.

With routing, you can have a *single* endpoint handler that can handle *multiple* URLs without having to resort to ugly query strings. From the point of the view of the endpoint handler, the query string and routing approaches are similar; the handler returns the results for the correct product dynamically as appropriate. The difference is that with routing, you can completely customize the URLs, as shown in figure 6.2. This feature gives you much more flexibility and can be important in real-life applications for search engine optimization (SEO).

NOTE With the flexibility of routing, you can encode the hierarchy of your site properly in your URLs, as described in Google's SEO starter guide at http://mng.bz/EQ2J.

